



Single-winged seeds spin like helicopter rotors.

Norway maple



Up to 200 seeds can be produced by a single flower.

Alder

Woody scales of the female catkin (flower spike) open up to release seeds.



Milk thistle

When the flower head dries out, it releases seeds with silvery parachutes.



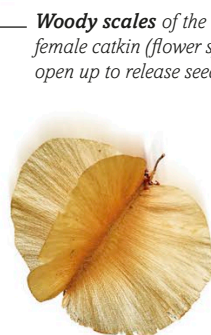
Coconut fruits are salt-proof and float on seawater.

Coconut

Acorns are essential fall food for many animals, from squirrels and woodpeckers to deer, pigs, and bears.



Acorn



Cuipo seeds have five wings, which make them spin as they fall.

Cuipo plants sprout as soon as their seeds land on the forest floor.



Cuipo

Wind and water carry seeds farthest. **Dandelion** and **milk thistle** seeds have parachutes that carry them on the breeze, while **maple** and **cuipo** seeds catch the wind as they fall from the tree canopy. Amazingly, **coconut** seeds can travel hundreds of miles on ocean currents. Animals are also important seed spreaders.

When animals eat fruit, the undigested seeds inside the fruit pass through their droppings. **Burdock** seeds are covered in hooks that get caught in animal fur and transported. Squirrels bury hundreds of **acorns** each fall to eat in winter. The ones they forget about germinate into new oak trees.